

4. (a) Supermarkets across the UK now charge customers a minimum of 5p for every plastic carrier bag supplied.

The reason for the charge is to reduce the number of plastic carrier bags used by consumers and therefore reduce waste and litter.

Since the introduction of the charge for plastic carrier bags in Wales, the number of these bags used by consumers has fallen by over 70 %.

Similarly, reports in England claim that supermarkets have issued 83 % fewer bags since the charge was introduced.

It is estimated that every person in the UK currently uses around 25 plastic carrier bags per year, compared to around 140 before charges were introduced.

The majority of the money retailers generate from sales of carrier bags is donated to good causes. A survey of retailers across England and Wales reported that £87 million had been donated to good causes since the introduction of the 5p charge, amounting to 4p for every bag sold.



- (i) Use the information in the passage to decide whether the following statements are **true** or **false**.

Put a tick (✓) in the correct column for each statement.

[3]

Statement	True	False
The number of plastic bags used in Wales and England has reduced since charging for them		
Retailers donate all the money generated from the sale of plastic bags to good causes		
Plastic bags are no longer used		
The charge for plastic bags has totally stopped their use in Wales		
The use of plastic bags leads to environmental problems		
The charge for plastic bags is beneficial to good causes		

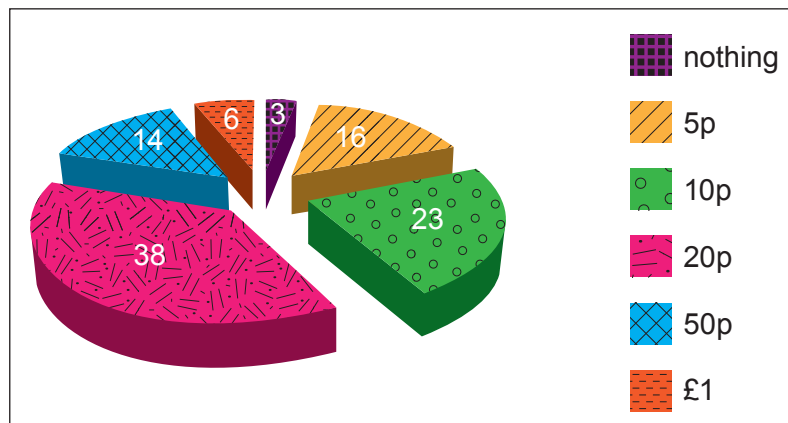


- (ii) How many fewer plastic bags will each person in the UK use over a 5-year period, based on the estimated number of bags used per person before and after the charge was introduced? [2]

Number of bags =

- (b) More than half of all consumers still regularly buy plastic bags.

The pie chart shows the results of a survey where 100 consumers were asked what is the most they would pay for a plastic bag.



Give the number of consumers that would be prepared to pay **more than** 5p for a plastic bag. [2]

Number of consumers =

- (c) Give **one** property of plastics which leads to long-term environmental problems. [1]

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